



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

STATE 2023

FINAL

Presentation Points	_____ (140 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

STATE FINAL SCENARIO KEY:

You've recently been promoted to a well-paying job in human resources at Digital Solutions. One of your key responsibilities is to log each store's time clock records into a spreadsheet. After working in this position for a few months, you notice that it appears that minors are working too late at night, working during school hours, and working too many hours per day. You know this is in violation of child-labor laws and state regulations.

- What are your next steps and why?
- Is it ethical for employers to treat employees differently based on their age?
- How will your decision(s) impact the company and the employees involved?
- What, if any, company ethics policies are involved in this scenario?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Page 3 - Open communication is conducting professional business with transparency and dual freedom to exchange information.
- Page 3- Equal opportunities is ensuring those around you and those you engage in business transactions are given the respect, honesty, and fairness needed to perform in the workplace.
- Page 3 - Digital Solutions' employees agree to uphold the following standards:
 - take responsibility for my actions, decisions, and obligations
 - make honest and transparent decisions which are good for all involved
 - present information in a clear and timely manner to all parties
 - encourage actions, policies, and procedures which promote high standards for conduct and professionalism
 - uphold and respect the laws that govern my work

- Page 3 – Your first responsibility is to know your own duties and how to do them properly, correctly, and pleasantly. Whatever your position, you have an important assignment: perform every task to the very best of your ability.
- Page 4 – Personal values versus company profits are often a source of conflict as are dilemmas triggered by breaches of confidentiality, personal bias, or illegal activity.
- Page 5 – Business ethics: prevent exploitation, harassment, and intimidation in the workplace. It's hard to break laws when your business practice is above-board and honest.
- Page 5 – Fairness: How you are treated by a superior or how you treat a subordinate directly impacts the quality of work and how work is performed.
- Page 5 – Integrity is the foundation on which good commerce is built and involves holding to your principles even when it would be easier or more profitable to compromise them.
- Page 6 – Paying respect to co-workers, oneself, and clients, being honest during any type of transaction, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional. Today's employees are looking for a workplace that exhibits positive ethical and professional values.
- Page 7 – Effective communication skills are essential if you plan to cultivate your career and will give you an advantage over most of your colleagues. Knowing how to efficiently communicate your message will enable you to increase the amount of influence that you will have in dealing with your peers, supervisors, and subordinates.
- Page 9 – Confidentiality is critical in many professional engagements and is key to organizational risk management and both personal and professional liability. When in doubt, maintain the confidence and seek professional counsel.